

Preliminary Bill #: assigned by YAG

Final Bill #: assigned by YAG

Assembly Committee #: assigned by YAG

Illinois Youth Legislature Seventy-Seventh Session

Senate Sponsor: Jack Smith

House Sponsor: Justin Wu

Co-Sponsors: Brent Meizelis, Will Dukes

Delegation: Sycamore High School

For an Act amending Chapter 20, Section 1370 of the Illinois Compiled Statutes relating to an innovation in the production of thermonuclear energy.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE YMCA YOUTH LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF ILLINOIS.

Section I. This bill shall provide for and ensure the creation of groundbreaking thermonuclear energy generation technology, and shall oversee the planning, acquisition, and construction of adequate facilities, specifically including, but not limited to, a uranium enrichment facility and a manufacturing facility, necessary for the operationalization of said technology. All resources requisite for this undertaking shall be procured from local producers operating within the State, and such producers shall be compensated for the provision of these resources through a mechanism distributing to them a portion of the economic benefits derived from the operational thermonuclear energy generation technology.

Section II. Any local producer who rejects the compensation mechanism established under this Act shall have their requisite resources subject to immediate and involuntary appropriation by the State.

Section III. For the purposes of financing the development, construction, and implementation of the thermonuclear energy generation technology authorized by this Act, the aggregate sum of three billion dollars, or so much thereof as may be necessary, is hereby appropriated to be expended over a period not to exceed three fiscal years. Said appropriation shall be derived from a composite of funding sources, to be constituted as follows:

(a) Approximately one billion two hundred fifty million dollars shall be obtained through the issuance of general obligation or revenue bonds of the State, bearing such interest rates, maturities, and terms as may be determined by the State Treasurer and approved by the General Assembly, with a maximum amortization period of twenty years.

(b) Approximately eight hundred million dollars shall be reallocated from existing capital improvement programs within the Rebuild Illinois capital plan or any successor capital funding mechanism, as determined by the Office of Management and Budget.

(c) Approximately five hundred million dollars shall be derived from grants, loans, or other financial instruments made available by the United States Department of Energy or any other federal entity, including but not limited to the Loan Programs Office, the Advanced Reactor Demonstration Program, and any credits or incentives authorized under the Inflation Reduction Act of 2022.

(d) Approximately three hundred million dollars shall be raised through a temporary and limited adjustment to the corporate income tax or by way of assessments imposed upon commercial energy utilities, as enacted by the General Assembly for the specific purpose of this program.

(e) Approximately one hundred fifty million dollars shall be drawn from the Budget Stabilization Fund or such other reserve accounts as the Comptroller and Treasurer shall jointly designate for one-time use in furtherance of this project.

All funds appropriated pursuant to this Section shall be deposited into a segregated account within the State Treasury to be known as the "Thermonuclear Development Fund," to be administered by the Department of Innovation and Technology in consultation with the Office of Management and Budget. Disbursement of said funds shall be contingent upon verification of need, conformity with federal and State procurement laws, and the availability of matching federal or private contributions where applicable.

Section IV. The Department of Innovation and Technology shall oversee the management of this project, including the administration of all financial accounts and resources requisite for the eventual and successful completion of the thermonuclear energy generation technology.

Section V. This bill shall go into effect upon the signature of the Youth Governor of the State of Illinois.

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BILL BRIEF

Delegation: Sycamore High School

Senate Sponsor: Jack Smith

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Legislative Intent: This bill shall instate a three-year fiscal plan for the development of a thermal nuclear energy generation device for use by the Illinois State government. The construction of this device will bring tremendous economic growth to the state as well as reduce the reliance on pollutant heavy energy generation technologies.

Evidence #1: As of August 2025, 286,000 eligible individuals are unemployed in the state of Illinois.

Source: Illinois Department of Employment Security
<https://ides.illinois.gov/newsroom/2025/sept/illinois-unemployment-rate-holds-steady--pay-roll-jobs-nearly-unc.html>

Analysis: Two hundred eighty six thousands unemployed individuals are two hundred eighty six thousands individuals who are not contributing to the income tax revenue, who are eating up welfare spending, and who live day to day under inhumane conditions that no one should be subject to. This bill will create thousands of entry level positions for the construction of the thermal nuclear energy generation device significantly reducing this number and creating a better life for the constituents of Illinois.

Statistical Evidence #2: A typical one thousand-megawatt plant (the equivalent of three million solar panels) only needs about a square mile to operate.

Source: US Department of Energy
<https://www.energy.gov/ne/articles/3-reasons-why-nuclear-clean-and-sustainable>

Analysis: This is only further proof that creating the facilities needed to manufacture thermonuclear energy devices would be a much safer and better choice than solar panels or wind turbines. The larger the footprint of land for the energy production facility, the larger the chance is that it will displace families and be destructive to the environment. Therefore, this is the best choice as it takes up relatively small space.